# The Noble Dhāraṇī Called Great Mahīndra

Āryamahāmahīndranāmadhāraṇī · Toh 887 · Derge Kangyur
འཕགས་པ་སྣང་དྲབ་པ་ཆོན་པ་ཞེས་བ་བྱའ་གི་ཟངྱས།

The Noble Dhāraṇī Called Great Mahīndra, known in Sanskrit as the Ārya Mahāmahīndra Nāma Dhāraṇī and in Tibetan as Phakpa Sai Wangpo Chenpo Zhe Jawai Zung, is a short scripture centered on a dhāraṇī, a sacred formula of protective and spiritual power. It opens in the classic sūtra style, recounting that the buddha Samantaprabha was staying in the dwelling of the brahmin Mahāmahīndra, a place attended by gods, and that the brahmin approached him, bowed at his feet, and sat to one side to address him. From this setting the text leads into the teaching and recitation of the dhāraṇī associated with the brahmin's name. The work is Toh 887 in the Kangyur, where it belongs among the dhāraṇī texts gathered in the canon's collections of incantations and protective formulas.

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In the language of India: ārya mahāmahīndra nāma dhāraṇī. In the language of Tibet: The Noble Dhāraṇī Called Great Mahīndra.

Homage to all the buddhas and bodhisattvas.

Thus did I hear at one time. The Blessed One, the perfectly and fully awakened buddha Samantaprabha, was staying in the dwelling of the brahmin Mahāmahīndra, who was like a great sāla tree, a place attended by gods. Then the brahmin Mahāmahīndra, who was like a great sāla tree, went to where the Blessed One, the perfectly and fully awakened buddha Samantaprabha, was. When he arrived, he bowed his head at the feet of the Blessed One, the perfectly and fully awakened buddha Samantaprabha, and sat down to one side. Seated to one side, the brahmin Mahāmahīndra, who was like a great sāla tree, said this to the Blessed One, the perfectly and fully awakened buddha Samantaprabha:

"Blessed One, I have made the aspiration for unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening. By what means will I remember my births? Blessed One, please explain well to me the method by which I will not forget the mind set on unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening."

When he had made this request, the Blessed One, the perfectly and fully awakened buddha Samantaprabha, said this to the brahmin Mahāmahīndra, who was like a great sāla tree:

"Therefore, son, if you aspire in this way, then take up this heart of the vidyā-mantra of Samantaprabha! Hold it! Read it! Master it completely! What is the heart of the vidyā-mantra of Samantaprabha?

tadyathā amodani pramodani vimodani saṃmodani priyaṃkaraṇi śrīkaraṇi śrākaraṇi bodhikaraṇi anuttarasyaṃ samyaksaṃbuddhakaraṇi anuttara āryakaraṇi anuttara prajñākaraṇi anuttara vaśīkaraṇi anuntara sarvakleśopakleśa vidhāraṇi apadyānadhakara vidhamani anuttara vidyā alokotpādani anutta śaikṣa śīla vidyācaraṇa vimukti guṇagaṇa saṃbhadhani unuttara sarvakuśala mūlodbhodani anuttari bhona mūlani anuttadāraga doṣa mohana mūlani anuttara śaikṣamana avidyā antakarā vidhamani anuttarāsī apratihata balacakra anuttarā sarvalārava vidrāmani tvaṃ hi bhadre anuttarā balabhadra subhadra śrībhadra anuttarabhadra samantabhadra asamasamabhadra anuttara mahāpuruṣabhadra anuttara mahāpuruṣa sepitā anuttara mahāpuruṣa anuvartanī anuttara mahāpuruṣa dharmadeśikā anuttara mahāpuruṣa dharmakoṣa saṃvārdhikā anuttara mahāburuṣa nirvāṇa anutta pratarṣikṣa tvaṃ hi bhadre gaṅgā sita pakṣu samyaksaṃbuddhe āsevitā bhāvitā bahulīkrodha stuta stauvita varṇitā praśasta

Son, this is the heart of the vidyā-mantra of Samantaprabha. Therefore, son, keep this heart of the vidyā-mantra of Samantaprabha in mind whether you are walking, standing, sitting, or lying down.

Son, whoever bears in mind this heart of the vidyā-mantra of Samantaprabha, whatever their name, family, or lineage may be, whether a man, a woman, a boy, or a girl, a god or a goddess, a nāga or a nāginī, a gandharva or a gandharvī, an asura or an asurī, a kinnara or a kinnarī, a male or female mahoraga, a male or female preta, a male or female piśāca, a male or female kumbhāṇḍa, a male or female pūtana, if they hold, read, transmit, teach, or explain this heart of the vidyā-mantra of Samantaprabha, they will remember their past lives for up to seven lifetimes. For as long as the cycle of existence lasts, they will not forget the mind set on unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening. Whether they become gods or humans, they will not meet an untimely death by weapons, poison, water, or fire.

Homage to the Blessed One, the perfectly and fully awakened buddha Samanta, the Victor, together with the lineage of Kāśyapa.
Homage to the Blessed One, the perfectly and fully awakened buddha Amitābha, the Victor, together with the lineage of Kāśyapa.
Homage to the Blessed One, the perfectly and fully awakened buddha

Amṛtaprabha, the Victor, together with the lineage of Kāśyapa.
Homage to the Blessed One, the perfectly and fully awakened buddha Mahāprabha, the Victor, together with the lineage of Kāśyapa.
Homage to the Blessed One, the perfectly and fully awakened buddha Asamaprabha, the Victor, together with the lineage of Kāśyapa.
Homage to the Blessed One, the perfectly and fully awakened buddha Asamasamaprabha, the Victor, together with the lineage of Kāśyapa.
Homage to the Blessed One, the perfectly and fully awakened buddha, the great sage Kāśyapa, together with his lineage: homage to these seven.
Homage to those who have entered the expanse of peace, together with their retinues. Homage!"

When the Blessed One had spoken thus, the brahmin Mahāmahīndra, who was like a great sāla tree, rejoiced and praised what the Blessed One had said.

This concludes the noble dhāraṇī called Great Mahīndra.

It was translated and edited by the Indian preceptors Jinamitra and Dānaśīla and the chief editor-translator, the monk Yeshé Dé, and then revised according to the new terminology and finalized.

## Translator's Notes

• The phrase "like a great sāla tree" applied to the brahmin seems to render the Sanskrit idiom brāhmaṇa-mahāśāla, "a brahmin of great wealth or standing". The phrase "a place attended by gods" renders a Tibetan expression meaning "endowed with gods"; it could also be the name of the dwelling. In the list of seven buddhas, the first name reads only "Samanta, the Victor" (or "All-Victorious"); it may stand for Samantaprabha, but it is given as written.

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## Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.